

Karol Jia

Baltimore, MD | rjia9@jh.edu | plasmelt.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Generative AI in Education · Learning Technologies · Instructional Design · Educational Equity · Evaluative Judgment

EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University

Baltimore, MD

Master of Science in Education

Aug 2025 – Aug 2026

Relevant coursework: Social Research; Statistics; Global Education Policy and Analysis; Qualitative Inquiry; Global Trends in Education.

The Ohio State University

Columbus, OH

B.S. in Business Administration, Fisher College of Business

Aug 2021 – Dec 2024

Major: Marketing (GPA 3.85/4.0) | Minor: History (GPA 3.9/4.0).

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Research Assistant — The China Model: Educational Influence and Convergence in Vietnam

Jun 2026 – Present

PI: Dr. Jennifer Adams

Baltimore, MD

- Compile and curate a corpus of Chinese education policy documents (1985–2025) for a comparative content analysis of China's educational influence on Vietnam.
- Support corpus-level analysis identifying discursive convergence, divergence, and policy translation across the Chinese and Vietnamese education systems within a multipolar, layered policy-diffusion framework.

Researcher — Multiagent LLM Scaffolding for Simulated Clinical Consultations

Mar 2026 – Present

Baltimore, MD

- Built and evaluated a multiagent large language model (LLM) system that distributes patient interaction, tutoring, checklist monitoring, and final feedback across specialized agents to scaffold simulated medical consultations.
- Found that multiagent scaffolding improved overall simulated-consultation quality—with gains concentrated in communication, including empathic expression and more detailed information gathering—rather than in diagnostic correctness.

Second Author — Hallucination-Aware Learning Research Project

Nov 2025 – Present

Baltimore, MD

- Co-developed a Hallucination-Aware Learning (HAL) framework for generative AI use in medical education.
- Examined how structured exposure to AI-generated errors may strengthen learners' verification skills, evaluative judgment, and critical engagement.
- Integrated theories of productive failure, cognitive friction, and AI-supported learning design to conceptualize instructional responses to hallucination risks.

Student Assistant — Ride4Refugee Project

Oct 2023 – Feb 2024

Columbus, OH

- Designed and distributed surveys to investigate transportation barriers and community needs among refugee populations in Columbus.
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative findings into a report with actionable recommendations for community stakeholders.
- Collaborated with the Central Ohio Transit Authority on solution-oriented planning, gaining experience in community-based research and policy-adjacent program implementation.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Jia, Karol. "When Discipline Becomes Ambiguous Harm: Rethinking Responsibility in School Responses." School of Education I.D.E.A.S. Conference, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD, April 17, 2026.

Jia, Karol. "Who Bears the Cost of Verification? Generative AI, Educational Equity, and Policy Challenges Across Educational Systems." WCCIET 2026 Annual Graduate Student Research Conference, George Washington University, Washington, DC, February 28, 2026.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Under review

"From Access to Verification: Reframing Equity in AI-Mediated Higher Education Assessment." Manuscript under review. (*First author*)

"Evaluating a Scaffolding-Oriented Multi-Agent Large Language Model System for Clinical Interview Training." Under review at *npj Digital Medicine*. (*Fourth author*)

"Negotiating Voice and Authorship in High-Stakes Second Language Writing under Generative AI: Private Help-Seeking and the Conditions of Invisibility." Under review at *Journal of Second Language Writing*; companion empirical study in IRB review. (*Co-first author & corresponding author*)

In preparation

"From Independent Evaluation to Supported Judgment: Rethinking AI Literacy for Older Adults in an Age of Synthetic Media." Manuscript in preparation. (*First author*)

"'For Your Own Good': Care, Benevolent Sexism, and the Misrecognition of Gendered Educational Norms." Manuscript in preparation. (*Sole author*)

HONORS & AWARDS

- Cum Laude, The Ohio State University, 2024.
- Dean's List (5 semesters), The Ohio State University.
- Allen Family Scholarship, The Ohio State University.

RESEARCH TOOLS & LANGUAGES

Research tools: Stata; SPSS; Qualtrics; Survey design; Zotero; Python; C++.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent); Cantonese (conversational); Korean (basic).